

India Tourist Travel Guide

For South African Citizens Travelling from China | June 2026

Traveller Nationality South African	Departing From: China	Destination India	Trip Type: Tourism
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STEP 1: Apply for India e-Tourist Visa (e-TV)

Visa Requirement

South African citizens CANNOT enter India without a visa. You must apply online for an India e-Tourist Visa before travelling. No walk-in or on-arrival visa is available.

How to Apply

1. Visit the official portal: <https://evisa.india.gov.in>
2. Select **e-Tourist Visa** and complete the online application form.
3. Upload a recent passport-size photo and a scanned copy of your passport bio-data page.
4. Pay the e-Visa fee using a credit/debit card (Visa, Mastercard, Amex accepted).
5. Receive your Electronic Travel Authorisation (ETA) by email — typically within 72 hours (allow up to 4 business days).
6. **Print the ETA** and carry it when you travel. Airlines check it at check-in.

Visa Details

Visa Type	India e-Tourist Visa (ETV)
Cost	USD \$100 – \$150 (varies by duration)
Processing Time	72 hours (up to 4 business days)
Validity	5 years from date of issue
Max Stay per Visit	Up to 180 days
Entry Type	Multiple entry
Valid Ports of Entry	29 airports and 5 seaports in India
Official Portal	evisa.india.gov.in

IMPORTANT: Apply for your visa at least 4-5 days before your flight. The e-TV is valid from the date of issue — NOT from the date of arrival in India.

STEP 2: Required Documents

Document	Details
Valid South African Passport	Minimum 6 months validity beyond planned India departure date
India e-Tourist Visa (ETA)	Printed copy of the approved ETA email

Return / Onward Ticket	Proof of onward travel out of India
Proof of Accommodation	Hotel bookings or invitation letter
Passport-size Photos	Recent colour photos (carry extras)
Travel Insurance	Strongly recommended — cover medical, trip cancellation
Proof of Sufficient Funds	Bank statement or sufficient cash/card

STEP 3: Flights from China to India

India-China air connectivity has been significantly restored in 2026, with several direct and connecting options available.

Direct Flight Routes (2026)

Route	Airline	Frequency	Notes
Shanghai (PVG) → Delhi (DEL)	Air India	5x/week	Boeing 787-8; launched Feb 2026
Beijing (PEK) → Delhi (DEL)	Air China	3x/week (Tue/Fri/Sun)	Airbus A330; restarted Apr 2026
Shanghai (PVG) → Kolkata (CCU)	IndiGo	Daily	Airbus A320neo; from Mar 2026
Kunming (KMG) → Kolkata (CCU)	China Eastern	6x/week	Resumed Apr 2026
Guangzhou (CAN) → Delhi (DEL)	China Southern	3-4x/week	Launching Summer-Autumn 2026

Tip: Book flights on Air India, Air China, IndiGo, China Eastern, or China Southern. For cities not listed above, connecting flights via Hong Kong, Bangkok, Singapore, or Dubai are widely available.

STEP 4: Top Tourist Destinations in India

Destination	Highlights	Best Time to Visit
New Delhi	India Gate, Red Fort, Qutub Minar, Humayun's Tomb	Oct – Mar
Agra	Taj Mahal, Agra Fort, Fatehpur Sikri	Oct – Mar
Jaipur (Rajasthan)	Amber Fort, City Palace, Hawa Mahal, Desert Safari	Oct – Mar
Goa	Beaches, Portuguese heritage, nightlife, water sports	Nov – Feb
Kerala	Backwaters, Munnar hill station, Ayurveda spas	Sep – Mar
Mumbai	Gateway of India, Marine Drive, street food, Bollywood	Nov – Feb
Varanasi	Ganges ghats, Kashi Vishwanath Temple, boat rides	Oct – Mar
Himachal Pradesh	Manali, Shimla, trekking, snow activities	Mar – Jun

STEP 5: Sample 14-Day Itinerary

Days	Location	Activities
Days 1–3	New Delhi	Arrive, India Gate, Red Fort, Humayun's Tomb, Chandni Chowk bazaar
Days 4–5	Agra	Taj Mahal at sunrise, Agra Fort, Fatehpur Sikri day trip

Days 6–7	Jaipur	Amber Fort, City Palace, Hawa Mahal, local markets (Pink City)
Days 8–9	Varanasi	Ganga Aarti ceremony, boat ride at dawn, Sarnath
Days 10–11	Mumbai	Gateway of India, Marine Drive, Elephanta Caves, street food
Days 12–14	Goa	Beach relaxation, Old Goa churches, water sports, seafood



STEP 6: Key Contacts & Resources

Resource	Details
India e-Visa Portal	evisa.india.gov.in
South African Embassy, New Delhi	+91-11-2614-9411 sahc.newdelhi@dirco.gov.za
India Tourism (Incredible India)	incredibleindia.org
Indian Railways Booking	irctc.co.in
Emergency (India)	Police: 100 Ambulance: 108 Tourist Helpline: 1363

Travel Plan prepared June 2026. Always verify visa and entry requirements at evisa.india.gov.in before travel.
Safe travels! Incredible India awaits you.